to Italy's Institute of Development in Automotive Engineering (IDEA), which had designed some famous cars such as the Alpha Romeo 155 in 1992. It had also worked on the Tata Indica and Indigo cars. Justin Norek, who was with IDEA and later shifted to Trilix SRL, Turin, made the conceptual drawings.

Wagh made the final design in India. But it was done under Ratan's watch. Besides overseeing the design, Ratan made changes to make the car more attractive, including reducing the sharp angle of its nose and extending it by 50 mm. He also gave it a mono wiper.

Finally, when the core team settled on a design, it turned out to be a stylish small car. In just twenty-four months since Ratan had shared his dream publicly at the Geneva Motor Show, the prototype of the Nano rolled out in April 2005 from the Tata Motors factory in Pune. But it turned out to be a disappointment. The single-cylinder engine seemed underpowered. Ratan was worried.

Tata Motors then redeveloped the engine. It produced a two-cylinder 540cc engine. But when it was fitted on the prototype, it again felt underpowered. The power had to be amped up several times before Wagh finally settled on a 624cc engine.

Tata Motors tied up with leading British engineering company Guest, Keen & Nettlefolds (GKN) for drive shafts and with Bosch, the German engineering and electronics giant, for the electronic engine management system. For tyres, it chose MRF to produce tubeless versions which, in addition to giving the vehicle a sleeker look, helped in saving weight and costs.

The car's body too underwent several modifications. Ratan, who stands more than six feet tall, pushed for its modification to accommodate tall passengers. Its foot pedal was also 'realigned to create more legroom'.

Through all these revisions, Ratan ensured that he did not compromise on quality to cut costs. The car met all the safety requirements of a modern vehicle with lower pollution levels than that of a two-wheeler. How did the team manage to do that? 'We shrunk the package of the car—we used less steel, we used less material, we had a smaller engine,' Ratan told *The Independent*. Along with that, the Nano was 'stripped of all unnecessary parts'—there was 'just one side mirror, one windscreen wiper, and no air conditioning, power steering, airbag or central locking'.